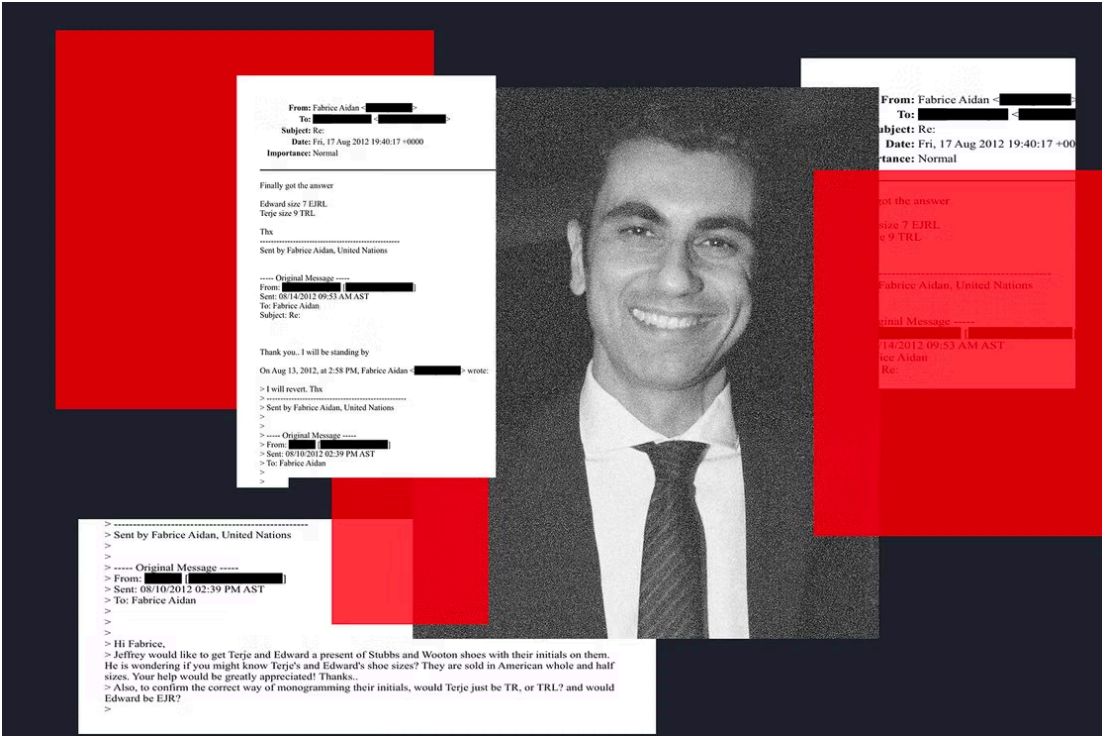


Epstein affair: French foreign ministry in turmoil after allegations against diplomat Fabrice Aidan

The Epstein files have exposed close ties between the French diplomat and the American sex offender, to whom he allegedly provided confidential information.

By Claire Gatinois and Philippe Ricard
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Fabrice Aidan in Paris, November 15, 2018. BERTRAND RINDOFF PETROFF/GETTY IMAGES/ LE MONDE

Discussing the case provoked anxious glances and a pervasive worry: Who would be the next diplomats implicated? How deeply would the foreign ministry be tarnished by the French connections to the Epstein scandal? Should there be a purge to put an end to the culture of secrecy that has long allowed the ministry to hide its officials' misconduct in order to protect France's image? The foreign ministry has been in turmoil since Tuesday, February 10, when Radio France and Mediapart revealed the links between diplomat Fabrice Aidan and Jeffrey Epstein, the American sex offender convicted as early as 2008 for "soliciting prostitution from a minor" and found dead in his jail cell in 2019.

Read more [Epstein's correspondence reveals links to French public figures](#)

